



FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS — INPATIENT ADMISSION

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Dept: Admissions and Inpatient Services, Blocks A and B | Valid Until: 31

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WARDS AND ROOMS

What types of wards are available?

Serendib General Hospital offers four inpatient accommodation categories: General Ward (4-bed, shared bathroom, standard meals), Semi-Private Ward (2-bed, shared bathroom), Private Room (attached bathroom, television, mini-refrigerator, one overnight companion), and Premium Suite (attached bathroom with bathtub, kitchenette, sofa bed, premium meal menu, complimentary Wi-Fi, dedicated ward nurse). ICU and HDU placements are clinically determined and not elective.

Can I request a specific ward type?

Yes, ward type preferences may be requested at the time of admission, subject to availability. In cases where the preferred ward is unavailable, patients will be accommodated in an available ward and transferred to their preferred category as soon as a vacancy arises. The admissions team will contact the patient's next of kin in such cases.

Can I upgrade my room after admission?

Room upgrades are possible subject to availability and must be requested through the ward nurse or the Admissions Desk (Ext. 1050). An additional deposit is collected to reflect the difference between ward categories. The upgrade takes effect upon availability and room preparation.

Can a family member stay overnight?

One adult companion may remain overnight in Private Rooms and Premium Suites. In General and Semi-Private Wards, overnight stays by visitors are not permitted except for parents of children in the Paediatric Ward, where one parent may remain throughout admission. ICU and HDU do not permit overnight companions.

DURING THE STAY

How do ward rounds work?

The treating consultant and their ward team conduct rounds once or twice daily, typically between 7:00 am and 9:00 am and again between 5:00 pm and 7:00 pm. During rounds, the team reviews the patient's condition, adjusts treatment plans, and discusses progress. Family members wishing to speak with the consultant should inform the ward nurse in advance so that a suitable time may be arranged.

What if I need a nurse urgently between rounds?

A nursing call bell is available at every bedside. Patients are encouraged to use it at any time without hesitation. Nursing staff are on duty 24 hours across all wards. Response times depend on workload but urgent calls are attended to immediately. Patients should not attempt to get up unassisted if feeling unsteady, particularly post-operatively.

Will I be informed about my diagnosis and treatment plan?

Yes. The treating consultant is obligated to discuss the diagnosis, proposed treatment, potential risks and benefits, and expected outcomes with the patient in a language they can understand. If interpretation is required, the Patient

Services Desk (Ext. 1100) can arrange this. Patients have the right to ask questions and to request written summaries of their care plan.

What meals are provided and can I request a special diet?

Standard meals are served at 7:30 am, 12:30 pm, and 6:30 pm. Dietary requirements including diabetic, low-sodium, low-fat, vegetarian, vegan, halal, and soft or pureed diets must be communicated to the ward nurse at admission. Premium Suite patients may order from an extended menu. Patients on prescribed therapeutic diets are reminded that outside food may conflict with their medical treatment and must seek ward nurse approval before consuming it.

Is Wi-Fi available?

Complimentary Wi-Fi is available in Private Rooms and Premium Suites. Paid Wi-Fi vouchers providing 24 hours of access at LKR 200 are available from the ward reception desk in General and Semi-Private Wards. The hospital's internal patient portal is accessible on all wards through the Serendib Wi-Fi network at no charge.

Can I use my mobile phone during admission?

Mobile phone use is permitted in all wards except the ICU and HDU. Patients are requested to keep ringtones on silent and to use phones considerately in shared wards. Phone calls and video calls should be conducted in the corridor or designated visitor areas where possible to avoid disturbing other patients.

Can I leave the ward temporarily during admission?

Patients are generally required to remain in the ward during their admission. In certain circumstances, a patient may request a short leave from the ward, such as for a religious obligation or essential family matter. This must be approved by the treating consultant or the on-call medical officer, and the patient must sign a leave form accepting responsibility for their wellbeing during the period of absence. Patients under active monitoring, IV drips, or post-operative observation are not eligible for ward leave.

DISCHARGE

What happens on the day of discharge?

The treating consultant will typically indicate anticipated discharge on the evening before. On the discharge day, the doctor signs the discharge order, the final bill is prepared, the discharge summary is written, and follow-up appointments are scheduled. This process takes approximately two to four hours. Patients are required to settle any outstanding balance before the discharge letter and prescriptions are issued.

Can I take my medical notes and reports home?

A printed discharge summary, investigation results generated during admission, and discharge prescriptions are provided to the patient at checkout. Original reports are retained in the hospital file; certified copies may be requested from the Medical Records Office. All records are also accessible through the patient portal within 24 hours of discharge.

D. Fernando

✓ **Digitally Signed**

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S. Jayasuriya

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